TEST I

LISTENING

PART 1

You will hear some sentences. You will hear each sentence twice. Choose the correct reply to each sentence (A, B, or C). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

1. A) Me too.
B) Can you?
C) Sure, you can.

2. A) Take bus 6.
B) It starts at 9 a.m. tomorrow.
C) It's in the center.

3. A) OK, here it is.
B) No, that doesn't suit you.
C) Sure, I'll wait here.

4. A) In the school library.
B) Since 1997.
C) Before I was born.

5. A) You should take a short break.
B) Let's get to work right now!
C) Don't worry, they haven't.

6. A) How about an ice-cream?
B) You need to wear your sweater.
C) Let's eat some fresh pizza and chips.

7. A) When does it happen?
B) Where did you see that?
C) Who told you that?

8. A) My hands are also firm.
B) Sounds like a boring person.
C) Can you expect anything?

PART 2

You will hear someone giving a talk. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space. Write ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each answer.

School trip

- Teacher's name: **Turner**
- They will visit by **(9)_____**
- The first activity they walk around **(10)_____**
- Students spend their free time in the **(11)_____**
- The lunch will be at **(12)_____** together
- They will visit a **(13)_____**
- They should bring a **(14)_____.**

PART 3

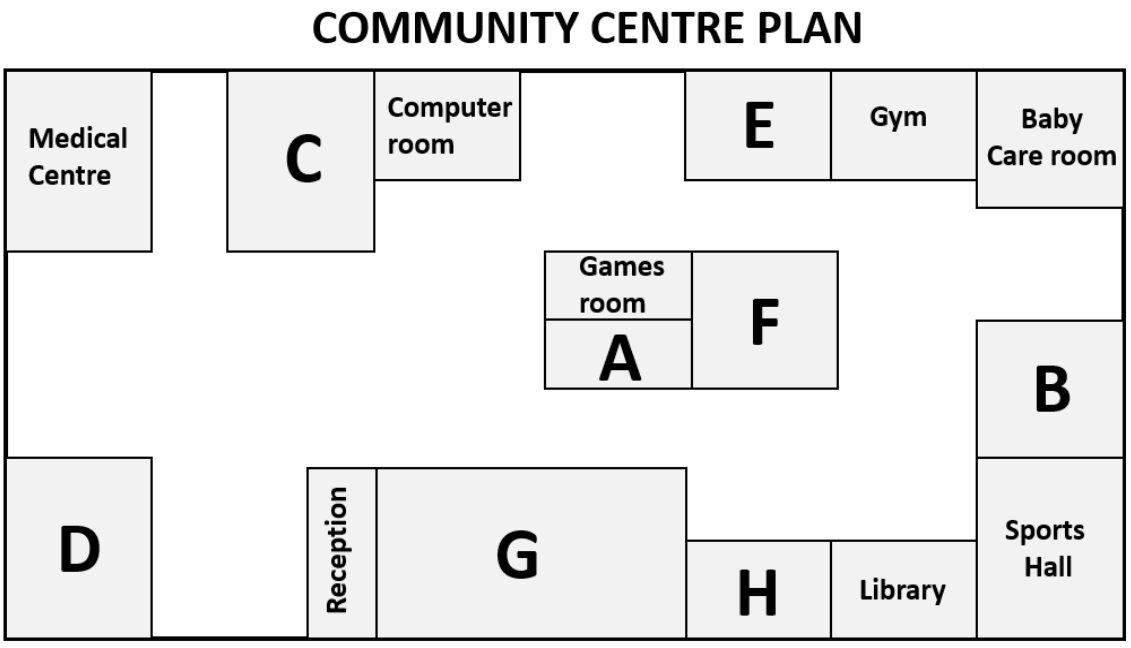
You will hear people speaking in different situations. Match each speaker (1-4) to the place they are at(A-F). There are TWO EXTRA options which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

15. Speaker 1 …
16. Speaker 2 …
17. Speaker 3 …
18. Speaker 4 …

A) In a swimming pool
B) At home
C) In a shopping centre
D) In a garden
E) In a restaurant
F) In a classroom

PART 4

You will hear someone giving a talk. Label the places (19-23) on the map (A-H). There are THREE extra options which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.



- **19.** Bike racks …
- **20.** Kitchen room …
- **21.** Music room …
- **22.** Shower room …
- **23.** Restroom …

PART 5

You will hear three extracts. Choose the correct answer (A, B or C) for each question (24-29). There are TWO questions for each extract. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Extract One

You hear a man and a woman discussing a new facility in their neighborhood.

24. What is the main conversation about?

A) A new library and its features

B) A recent community event

C) Renovations at the local museum

25. What is the woman concerned about?

A) The lack of seating

B) There are too many people in the evenings

C) The opening hours are too short

Extract Two

You hear two friends talking about a coffee shop they visited.

26. What is the main conversation about?

A) The menu options at a café

B) The location of a popular café

C) The size and atmosphere of a new coffee shop

27. What did the man say about the new coffee shop?

A) The service was slower

B) The prices were higher

C) The staff weren't friendlier

Extract Three

You hear a conversation between two people discussing pets.

28. What is the main conversation about?

A) The difficulty of taking care of a pet animal

B) Choosing the right breed for a family

C) Training a dog to behave indoors

29. What was the woman's recommendation?

A) Going for a smaller one

B) Buying a pet from a shelter

C) Hiring a professional trainer

PART 6

You will hear a part of a lecture. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space. Write no more than ONE WORD for each answer.

MARKETING AND BRANDING



- A strong brand can help a company dominate its **(30)_____**.
- Apple products are considered more valuable because of their high **(31)_____**.
- Many brands focus less on selling logic and more on selling **(32)_____**.
- After drinking Coca-Cola, customers don’t notice the ingredients but experience a feeling of **(33)_____**.
- Online businesses track customer preferences using **(34)_____** history.
- This data helps improve both the customer experience and overall **(35)_____**.

READING

PART 1

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

THE GREAT WALL OF CHINA



The Great Wall of China is one of the most famous landmarks in the world. It was built to protect China from attacks. Construction of the wall began over two thousand years ago during the Qin Dynasty. Different dynasties added to the wall over time, making it longer and stronger. Today, the **(1)_____** stretches over 13,000 miles across mountains, deserts, and plains. The **(2) _____** of the wall is incredible, as it took millions of workers to build it. Many people call it the "longest wall in the world."

The Great Wall was not just for defense. It also helped regulate trade along the Silk Road. Soldiers and guards also used the wall to **(3)_____** the movement of goods and people. Watchtowers were built to send signals in case of **(4)_____.** These towers gave the wall a better **(5) _____** system.

Parts of the wall have been restored, while others have crumbled over the years. Tourists from around the world visit to see this ancient structure. Some sections are steep and hard to climb, but the view from the top is worth the effort. The Great Wall is a symbol of China's unity and strength. It shows how **(6)_____** people worked together to achieve something great. This remarkable monument continues to amaze people today.

PART 2

Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only. There are TWO extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A. You are a university student looking for a job you can do on Saturdays and Sundays.

B. You are a parent who needs someone to care for your young children in the afternoons.

C. You have just graduated with a design degree and have a great collection of your work, but no job history.

D. You are a native French speaker looking for flexible work you can do from home.

E. You are a highly experienced software architect with strong management skills.

F. You want a weekday job that finishes by noon so you can have your afternoons free.

G. You are a former nurse with several years of experience working in a hospital.

H. You have a talent for organization and have previously worked for a delivery company.

I. You are a skilled builder with over ten years of experience in the construction industry.

J. You have been working as a primary school teacher for the last five years.

7. Junior Graphic Designer

We are a fast-growing marketing agency looking for a creative individual to join our team. This is an entry-level position, so professional experience is not a prerequisite, but a strong portfolio demonstrating your design skills is essential. Full training on our software suite will be provided. Must be a team player.

8. Part-Time Barista

Our friendly neighbourhood coffee shop needs a barista for morning shifts (7 am - 12 pm), Monday to Friday. The ideal candidate will have excellent customer service skills and a passion for coffee. Previous experience is a plus but not required, as we are happy to train the right person.

9. Senior Backend Developer

A leading tech firm is seeking an experienced developer to lead our server-side engineering team. Candidates must have a minimum of 8 years of experience with Python and cloud infrastructure (AWS/Azure). This is a leadership role that involves mentoring junior developers and architecting new systems.

10. Weekend Event Staff

We run large-scale public events (concerts, festivals) and require reliable staff for weekend work. Duties include ticket scanning, guiding attendees, and light setup/cleanup. This is a flexible, seasonal role, perfect for those looking to earn extra money on Saturdays and Sundays.

11. Clinical Research Associate

A pharmaceutical company is hiring a professional with a background in nursing or a related medical field. The role involves monitoring clinical trials, ensuring patient safety, and managing data. A degree in life sciences and at least 3 years of experience in a hospital or research setting are required.

12. Foreign Language Content Reviewer

We need fluent speakers of German or French to review and edit translated documents for accuracy and cultural appropriateness. This is a remote, project-based role. You must be a native-level speaker of the target language and have a keen eye for detail.

13. Logistics Coordinator

A busy shipping company is looking for an organized individual to manage schedules, track shipments, and communicate with drivers. Experience in logistics or supply chain management is highly desirable. Must be proficient with office software and able to solve problems under pressure.

14. Childminder / Nanny

A family is looking for a caring and responsible person to look after their two children (ages 4 and 7) after school. Responsibilities include school pick-up, preparing snacks, and helping with homework. Must have a clean driving record and previous childcare experience.

PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

LIST OF HEADINGS:

A) A summary of the decree inscribed on the stone
B) The far-reaching consequences of the discovery
C) An accidental find of major significance
D) A feature that provided the essential key
E) Ongoing debate over the object's rightful home
F) An analysis of the stone's geological composition
G) Acknowledging a principal figure's success
H) The specific strategy that unlocked the code

15. Paragraph I
16. Paragraph II
17. Paragraph III
18. Paragraph IV
19. Paragraph V
20. Paragraph VI

THE ROSETTA STONE

I. In 1799, during Napoleon's campaign in Egypt, a French soldier named Pierre-François Bouchard made an unexpected discovery in the town of Rosetta. He found a large, dark stone slab inscribed with text. Recognizing its potential importance, the slab was secured. It was immediately clear that this was no ordinary artifact, as it appeared to contain the same text written in three different scripts, presenting a linguistic puzzle that had confused scholars for centuries.

II. The true value of the Rosetta Stone lay in its trilingual inscription. The top section was written in Ancient Egyptian hieroglyphs, the script of monuments and religious texts which no one at the time could read. The middle section was in Demotic, a more common script used in ancient Egypt for everyday purposes. The bottom section was in Ancient Greek, a language that was well

understood by scholars. It was this trilingual format that provided the pivotal clue for finally decoding the lost language of the pharaohs.

III. For over two decades, many scholars attempted to decipher the hieroglyphs with limited success. The final breakthrough came from a young French scholar named Jean-François Champollion. He had dedicated his life to the study of ancient Egypt and, in 1822, he announced his success. By building on the work of others and applying his own profound knowledge of Coptic (a language descended from Ancient Egyptian), he was able to unlock the secrets of the hieroglyphic script.

IV. Champollion's method was both systematic and brilliant. He hypothesized that the hieroglyphs enclosed in oval shapes, known as cartouches, represented the names of royal figures. By comparing the Greek names of pharaohs like Ptolemy and Cleopatra with the hieroglyphs in the corresponding cartouches, he was able to assign phonetic values to many of the hieroglyphic symbols. This phonetic approach, rather than treating each symbol as a picture of a word, was the crucial step that allowed the entire system to be understood.

V. The decipherment of the Rosetta Stone was a watershed moment in history. It didn't just allow one text to be read; it opened the door to understanding thousands of other inscriptions and papyri from ancient Egypt. For the first time, historians could read the history, literature, and religious beliefs of the Egyptians in their own words. This single discovery essentially gave birth to the entire field of modern Egyptology and unveiled the complexities of a civilization that had been silent for nearly two millennia.

VI. After the defeat of the French forces in Egypt in 1801, the Rosetta Stone was transferred to British possession under the terms of a treaty. It has been on public display at the British Museum in London since 1802, where it remains the single most visited object. However, its location is a source of ongoing contention, with Egyptian authorities and cultural heritage groups frequently calling for its repatriation to Egypt, arguing it is a vital piece of their national heritage.

PART 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

DAYDREAMING

In today's busy society, people often see daydreaming as a waste of time — a sign that someone is lazy or unable to focus. From classrooms to workplaces, being caught staring into space is usually considered a bad habit that needs to be corrected. However, recent research suggests that allowing our minds to wander freely might actually have important benefits for creativity, problem-solving, and emotional well-being.

For many years, psychologists believed that daydreaming prevented people from concentrating on real-world tasks. But a growing number of scientists now argue that the human brain is never completely at rest. Even when we are not focused on anything in particular, a network in our brain known as the default mode network becomes active. This system is responsible for imagination, self-reflection, and connecting different ideas — all of which are essential for innovative thinking.

Dr. Kalina Christoff, a neuroscientist at the University of British Columbia, has studied the brain activity of people while they daydream. Her research shows that moments of mental drifting can help the brain make unexpected connections, leading to sudden insights. She explains that when the mind is allowed to move freely from one thought to another, it can link distant memories or ideas in original ways — a process that structured, focused thinking often prevents.

To explore this idea further, a group of psychologists conducted an experiment in which participants were asked to perform a creative task after either resting quietly or doing a simple, repetitive activity such as sorting colored paperclips. Those who had a chance to let their minds wander during the dull activity produced more imaginative ideas than those who didn't. According to the researchers, these results indicate that mild mental distraction gives the subconscious mind time to process information in the background.

Moreover, daydreaming might also play a role in emotional balance. When people think about their goals, memories, or relationships during idle moments, they are engaging in a kind of mental rehearsal that can prepare them for future situations. In moderation, this helps individuals reflect on their feelings and build empathy. However, experts inform that too much or negative daydreaming — for instance, repeatedly imagining stressful or unrealistic scenarios — can lead to anxiety or dissatisfaction.

In the modern world, where people are constantly connected to screens and notifications, genuine mental pauses have become rare. Psychologists suggest that taking short breaks without digital distractions can help restore mental energy and reduce stress. So, rather than trying to eliminate daydreaming, perhaps we should embrace it as a natural and valuable function of the mind.

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21. What was traditionally believed about daydreaming?

A) It improves people's ability to concentrate.

B) It is a sign of deep thinking and self-awareness.

C) It stops people from focusing properly on tasks.

D) It helps people become more productive at work.

22. According to Dr. Christoff, what happens when the mind drifts?

A) It becomes unable to connect different ideas.

B) It finds creative links between thoughts and memories.

C) It stops processing information altogether.

D) It repeats the same thought patterns endlessly.

23. What did the experiment involving paperclips demonstrate?

A) Daydreaming reduces people's ability to think logically.

B) Repetitive tasks increase stress and anxiety.

C) Focused concentration produces better ideas.

D) A relaxed mental state can enhance creativity.

24. What warning do experts give about daydreaming?

A) It can have harmful effects if done excessively.

B) It always results in emotional stability.

C) It is less effective than using digital tools.

D) It should be avoided during leisure activities.

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25. The default mode network becomes inactive when people are daydreaming.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

26. Dr. Christoff's research proves that daydreaming increases intelligence levels.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

27. Participants who did a boring activity before the creative task failed to generate more unique ideas.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

28. Excessive daydreaming can sometimes contribute to adverse emotions.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

29. The writer suggests that technology use has reduced opportunities for genuine mental rest.

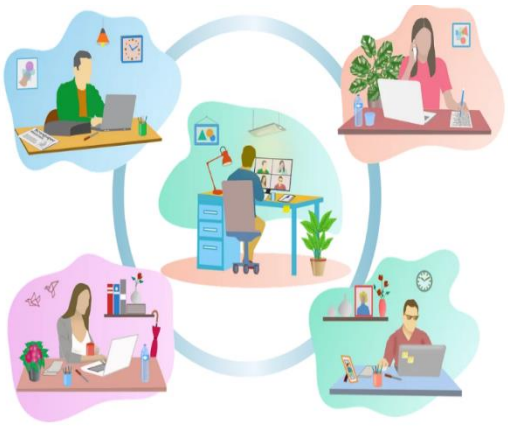
A) True B) False C) Not Given

PART 5

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

THE TELECOMMUTING PARADIGM

The paradigm of the traditional workplace is undergoing a seismic shift. Telecommuting, once a niche arrangement, has become increasingly prevalent across numerous sectors. Industries from technology to legal philosophy are progressively embracing flexible work models, permitting staff to operate remotely, at least on a hybrid basis. Nevertheless, the once-futuristic prophecy of near-vacant office buildings—populated only by essential maintenance or on-site personnel—remains a distant reality.



The tangible merits for employers are compelling. A distributed workforce mitigates the necessity for vast, costly office real estate. Furthermore, empirical data suggests a significant uptick in output. North American studies, for instance, indicate that remote employees can be 30-40% more prolific. Manager James Horgan posits that this surge is partially attributable to the elimination of the arduous daily commute. 'Our findings revealed a pattern of reinvestment; the time recuperated from travel was largely channeled back into professional tasks,' Horgan explains.

'This new-found autonomy was highly valued, and in a gesture of reciprocity, employees demonstrated their commitment through heightened productivity.'

Beyond productivity, offering remote work serves as a powerful tool for talent acquisition and retention. The societal dividends are equally profound. Telecommuting fosters greater workforce inclusivity, democratizing access to employment for demographics that have historically faced barriers. This includes not only primary caregivers for the elderly or infirm, but also individuals with disabilities and those residing in geographically isolated regions. An ancillary benefit is the potential for enhanced civic engagement, as the temporal flexibility afforded by remote work allows individuals to participate more fully in local community life.

The endurance of the physical office, however, is rooted in more than mere tradition. Many organizations contend that the serendipitous collaboration and rapid innovation that fuel growth are best fostered in a shared environment. The organic process of mentorship, whereby junior staff absorb professional nuances through informal observation—a kind of corporate osmosis—is notoriously difficult to replicate virtually. The office thus remains a crucial crucible for forging company culture and a tangible sense of collective identity, elements that risk dilution within a fully atomized workforce.

However, this model is not without its detriments. A significant portion of the remote workforce grapples with feelings of isolation and the absence of the spontaneous, collegial camaraderie inherent in a physical office. Moreover, the erosion of clear boundaries between professional duties and personal time can make achieving a sustainable work-life equilibrium challenging. Consequently, it is incumbent upon employers to implement proactive support structures, such as regular virtual team-building activities and robust mental wellness programs, to ensure their distributed teams remain cohesive, motivated, and psychologically sound.

For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each question.

THE RISE OF REMOTE WORK

The practice of telecommuting is now common in various fields, including the technology and **(30)**_____ sectors. For companies, a key advantage is a reduced need for physical office space. For employees, productivity can see a significant surge of up to **(31)**_____ percent. This increase is partly explained by the removal of the daily **(32)**_____**,** with the saved time often being redirected into work. From a societal perspective, remote work promotes inclusivity by opening up job opportunities for groups such as caregivers and people living in **(33)**_____ areas.

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34. According to the text, what is a key psychological driver behind the increased productivity of remote workers?

A) They face fewer interruptions from colleagues compared to an office environment.

B) They feel a sense of obligation to repay the company for the flexibility it provides.

C) Their performance is more easily and accurately measured through digital tools.

D) They have access to superior and more personalized technology in their home offices.

35. What does the author imply is a crucial responsibility for companies with a remote workforce?

A) To subsidize the cost of home office equipment for all employees.

B) To actively prevent the potential for employee burnout through targeted support.

C) To decrease reliance on virtual meetings to combat screen fatigue.

D) To ensure all employees have equal access to high-speed internet.

WRITING

You are a student at a school that is planning to change the canteen menu. You received an email from the canteen manager.

Dear Student,

We are currently reviewing the school canteen menu and would like to include healthier and more popular food options. What types of food would you like to see more of? Are there any meals or snacks we should remove or improve?

Your feedback is important to us.

Best regards,

Canteen Manager

Task 1.1

Write a short email to your friend (who also eats at the school canteen).

Say what you think about the food and what changes you would like to see in the menu.

Write about 50 words.

Task 1.2

Write an email to the canteen manager.

Give your opinion about the current canteen menu and suggest improvements.

Mention what kind of food should be added or removed and explain why.

Write 120–150 words.

Task 2

You are participating in an online discussion for language learners.

The question is: "Some schools require students to wear uniforms, while others allow casual clothes. Do you think wearing a uniform is a good idea?"

Post your response, giving reasons and examples.

Write 180-200 words.

SPEAKING

PART 1.1

- **What do you usually do in your free time?**
- **Do you enjoy sports?**
- **How often do you go to the gym?**

PART 1.2





- Tell me what you can see in these two pictures.
- What are the benefits of spending time with friends?
- Is it important to make friends?

PART 2



- **Tell me about the time when you learned a new skill.**
- **What was it and how did you learn it?**
- **What kinds of skills are most useful in today's world?**

PART 3

SOCIAL MEDIA HAS A NEGATIVE IMPACT ON SOCIETY	
Pros:	**Cons:**
• Social media helps people stay connected around the world, making it easier to stay connected with others. • It provides a platform for sharing information, promoting causes, and raising awareness. • It can be a tool for entertainment, education, and networking.	• Social media can contribute to feelings of isolation or loneliness. • It can be a source of misinformation or fake news. • It can negatively impact on mental health, leading to issues like anxiety or low self-esteem.

TEST II

LISTENING

PART 1

You will hear some sentences. You will hear each sentence twice. Choose the correct reply to each sentence (A, B, or C). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

1. A) So good to see you again.
B) Yes, she is very old.
C) No, you aren't her.

2. A) I'm lovely, thank you.
B) I met someone yesterday.
C) Lovely to meet you too!

3. A) My home is very big.
B) I'm from Valencia.
C) There are many parks.

4. A) Yeah, that's him.
B) No, they are.
C) Yes, that did.

5. A) You can also join our club.
B) No, it is nice of them to leave.
C) Yes, I'm happy to be here.

6. A) Never mind.
B) You're right.
C) Yeah, we can.

7. A) Yeah!
B) Sure!
C) Nice!

8. A) I am very tall these days.
B) I am twenty-five years old.
C) I've been great, thanks!

PART 2

You will hear someone giving a talk. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space. Write ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each answer.

NEW GYM

- Manager's name: Emma **(9)_____**
- Opening shift at: **(10)_____**
- The gym placed at the **(11)_____** floor.
- You must wear: **(12)_____** shoes.
- If you work at: **(13)_____** you get a list of participant check-ins and others.
- You place your private items in **(14)_____**

PART 3

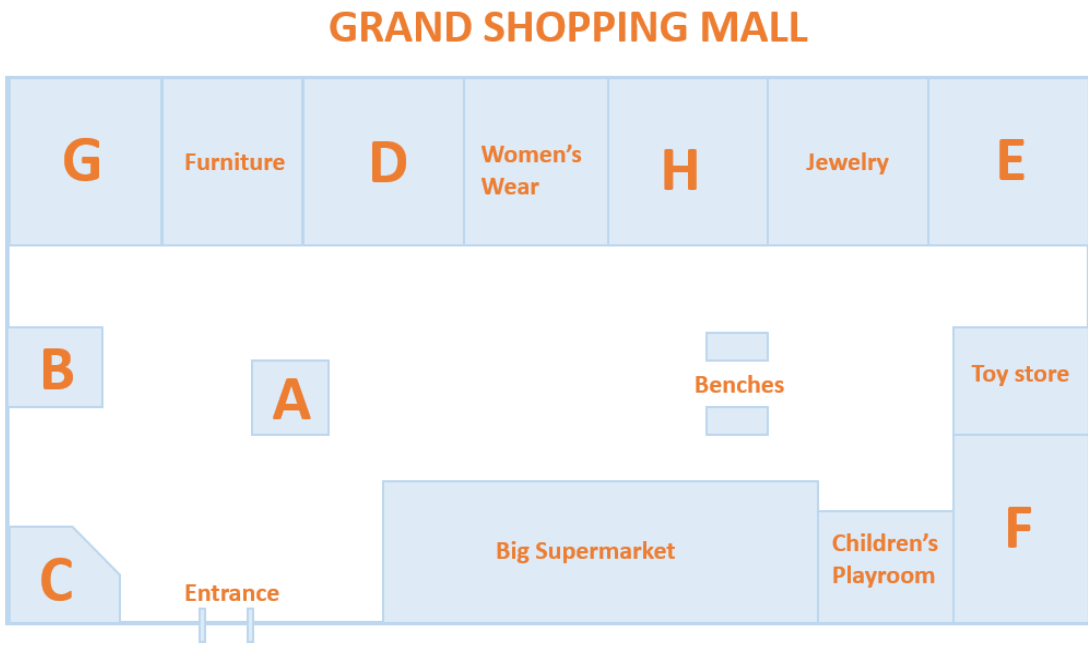
You will hear people speaking in different situations. Match each speaker (1-4) to the place they are at(A-F). There are TWO EXTRA options which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

15. Speaker 1 …
16. Speaker 2 …
17. Speaker 3 …
18. Speaker 4 …

A) Arrange to study with another person.
B) Make sure you have a comfortable place to sit.
C) Listening to music will help you to concentrate.
D) Don't eat too much while you're studying.
E) Study in the morning when your mind is clearer.
F) Set yourself a series of targets to achieve.

PART 4

You will hear someone giving a talk. Label the places (19-23) on the map (A-H). There are THREE extra options which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.



- **16.** Café …
- **17.** Kiosk …
- **18.** Men's wear …
- **19.** Accessories …
- **20.** Children's clothes …

PART 5

You will hear three extracts. Choose the correct answer (A, B or C) for each question (24-29). There are TWO questions for each extract. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Extract One

24. The man's article wasn't on this issue because …

A) he forgot to send it to the editor.

B) he didn't have enough time to complete it.

C) he thinks the next issue will be better.

25. What does the woman think of the short stories?

A) They are very amusing.

B) They are not many.

C) They are not true to life.

Extract Two

26. What is the relationship between the speakers?

A) Doctor and nurse.

B) School principal and teacher.

C) Secretary and patient.

27. The doctor …

A) is arriving soon.

B) has just had a break.

C) is examining someone.

Extract Three

28. Why is the woman unhappy with the item she bought?

A) Its quality is poor.

B) She doesn't like its style.

C) The color doesn't suit her.

29. What will the woman receive?

A) Her money back.

B) A different clothing item.

C) A gift card.

PART 6

You will hear a part of a lecture. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space. Write no more than ONE WORD for each answer.

WILLIAM THE CONQUEROR



- William the Conqueror defeated the **(30)**_____ army in 1066
- The words beef, hour, fruit and **(31)**_____ all entered the English language from French.
- Gothic **(32)**_____ architecture also arrived in England from France.
- Construction of Wells Cathedral started in **(33)**_____.
- It was **(34)**_____ in 1490.
- Wells Cathedral is one of twenty-six cathedrals in England. This **(35)**_____ is called the medieval cathedrals of England.

READING

PART 1

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

THE MAGIC OF THE NORTHERN LIGHTS



The Northern Lights, also known as the Aurora Borealis, are a spectacular natural light show visible in high-latitude regions. This phenomenon is caused by electrically charged particles from the sun colliding with gases in the Earth's atmosphere. The result is a wonderful display of dancing lights in the night sky. These beautiful **(1)**_____ can appear in many colors, though pale green and pink are the most common. The specific **(2)**_____ that are present in the atmosphere, such as oxygen and nitrogen, determine the colors we see.

For centuries, these lights have **(3)**_____ debates among scientists. Many ancient cultures believed the lights were spirits or gods. Today, science provides a clear explanation for this amazing **(4)**_____**.** The sun continuously sends out a stream of particles called the solar wind. When this solar wind reaches Earth, our planet's magnetic field funnels the **(5)**_____ toward the polar regions. This interaction creates the vibrant colors that mesmerize observers.

The best time to witness the Aurora Borealis is on a clear, dark night far from city light pollution. While the beauty is undeniable, the science behind the lights is just as fascinating. Understanding how particles from the **(6)**_____ create this celestial ballet only adds to the wonder of the experience.

PART 2

Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only. There are TWO extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A. You are travelling by yourself, want to keep costs low, and are eager to socialise with other travellers.
B. You and your partner want a digital detox for a weekend, completely away from emails and social media.
C. Your job requires you to travel for a business trip where you'll need professional amenities and a reliable workspace.
D. You prefer a place where the mountain feels just a few steps away and comfort awaits you the moment you stop skiing.
E. You're starting a contract job in a new city for several weeks and need a place that offers more independence and home comforts than a hotel.
F. You want to book a holiday where the total cost is fixed in advance, covering all your food and entertainment.
G. You are bored with standard chain hotels and want to stay somewhere that reflects the local artistic scene.
H. You need accommodation that provides full-board catering for a large tour group.
I. You are looking for a hotel that offers a complimentary shuttle service to the airport.
J. You need accommodation with facilities specifically designed to keep your young children entertained.

7. The Grand Plaza Hotel
Located in the heart of the financial district, our hotel offers executive suites with high-speed internet, a 24-hour business center, and meeting rooms. Perfect for the discerning corporate traveller.

8. Sunset Beach Resort (All-Inclusive)
Leave your wallet at home! Our all-inclusive package includes all meals, drinks, and activities. Enjoy our private beach, multiple swimming pools, and nightly enjoyment. Ideal for a stress-free holiday.

9. The Backpacker's Hub
Offering cheap dormitory beds and a lively social atmosphere, we're the top choice for solo travellers on a tight budget. Features include a shared kitchen, a common room with games, and nightly pub crawls.

10. "The Nest" - Secluded Forest Cabin

Escape the city and reconnect with nature. Our cozy, self-catering cabin for two is located deep in the woods, with no Wi-Fi or television. It features a fireplace and a porch with stunning views. The perfect romantic getaway.

11. Family Fun Villas

Our spacious two- and three-bedroom villas are perfect for families. Each comes with a full kitchen, a private garden, and access to the kids' club and a child-friendly swimming pool. We are located just a 5-minute drive from the main theme park.

12. The Art-House Boutique Hotel

Each of our 12 rooms is uniquely designed by a local artist. We are situated in the cultural quarter, surrounded by galleries, theatres, and independent cafes. A unique experience for those who appreciate creativity and style.

13. Mountain Peak Lodge

Situated at the base of the ski slopes, we offer ski-in/ski-out access. Our facilities include equipment rental, a sauna to relax your muscles after a long day on the mountain, and a hearty breakfast buffet.

14. City Centre Serviced Apartment

A home away from home. Our apartments are available for weekly or monthly rentals and include a fully equipped kitchen, washing machine, and separate living area. Ideal for longer stays or for those who prefer more independence compered to a hotel offers.

PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

LIST OF HEADINGS:

A) The financial cost of implementing smart technology
B) Examples of how technology can improve urban life
C) The risk of excluding non-tech-savvy citizens
D) A definition of the core concept
E) The importance of citizen participation in planning
F) Concerns regarding data privacy and surveillance
G) The technological backbone of a smart city
H) A historical look at city planning

15. Paragraph I
16. Paragraph II
17. Paragraph III
18. Paragraph IV
19. Paragraph V
20. Paragraph VI

THE CONCEPT OF SMART CITIES

I. A "smart city" is an urban area that uses various types of electronic methods and sensors to collect data. Insights gained from that data are used to manage assets, resources, and services efficiently. The ultimate goal is to improve the quality of life for its citizens by making urban operations and services more effective and responsive to their needs.

II. The foundation of any smart city is a robust and integrated network of information and communication technology (ICT). This includes the Internet of Things (IoT), where everyday objects are embedded with sensors and connected to the internet. These sensors can be placed in everything from streetlights and rubbish bins to public transport and water pipes, all feeding real-time information into a central system for analysis.

III. The practical applications of this technology are vast. For instance, smart traffic management

systems can analyze live traffic flow to adjust traffic light timings, reducing congestion and pollution. Smart grids can optimize energy distribution, preventing blackouts and promoting the use of renewable energy. Connected rubbish bins can signal when they are full, allowing for more efficient waste collection routes.

IV. While the potential benefits are significant, the development of smart cities raises serious questions about privacy. The constant collection of data on citizens' movements, energy use, and daily habits could be misused. There is a risk of creating a surveillance society where personal information is vulnerable to cyberattacks or used for social control. Establishing strong data protection regulations and transparent policies is therefore essential.

V. Another critical challenge is ensuring that the benefits of a smart city are accessible to all residents. There is a danger of creating a "digital divide," where those who are less comfortable with technology, often the elderly or low-income groups, are left behind. If services like public transport or healthcare access become primarily app-based, it could create new barriers for those without smartphones or digital literacy skills.

VI. Engagement of residents is a crucial element in the development of smart cities. Without the input of residents, urban planners may develop solutions that fail to address the actual needs of the community. Public consultations, participatory design workshops, and open forums can help ensure that smart city initiatives are inclusive and reflect the priorities of all citizens, fostering trust and collaboration between governments and the public.

PART 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

THE DIGITAL SHIFT

The transition to remote work was, at first, liberating. For the first few months, I relished the flexibility. No more crowded morning commutes, the freedom to structure my day, and the quiet focus I could achieve without the constant interruptions of a busy office. I felt my productivity soar, and the work-life balance I had long chased seemed finally within my grasp. However, this initial honeymoon phase began to fade as a new kind of pressure slowly crept in: the tyranny of the digital leash.

The source of this pressure wasn't a single policy or a demanding boss, but a collective, unspoken

set of expectations that our team had developed. The constant 'ping' of instant messages created an obligation to be perpetually connected. Emails sent late at night seemed to demand an immediate response, blurring the lines between work and personal time until they were almost non-existent. The culture had shifted from 'working from home' to 'living at work'.

This came to a head during a critical project with a tight deadline. I needed some vital data from a colleague, Mark, to complete my section. I sent him a message on our team chat, then an email. Hours passed in what I call 'digital silence'. My anxiety escalated as my mind raced with possibilities – was he ignoring the messages? Was he annoyed about something? I imagined the worst, and my frustration grew, stalling my progress entirely. By late afternoon, I was convinced the project was in jeopardy because of his lack of response.

Just as I was about to escalate the issue to our manager, a call came through from Mark. He sounded apologetic and flustered. It turned out his home internet connection had been down all day, and his messages to me, explaining the situation and providing the data from his phone, had been failing to send due to a temporary network glitch on his end. The fault wasn’t with Mark, but with our communication methods and the assumptions they encouraged. It was an epiphany for me; the real issue wasn't a lack of commitment from anyone, but the chaotic, high-anxiety system of communication we had fallen into.

That evening, I decided to be proactive. I spent a few hours drafting what I called a 'communications charter,' which I then proposed to my team leader before sharing it with the wider team. It wasn't revolutionary, but it set clear expectations: defined core working hours for communication, an agreement on expected response times (e.g., 24 hours for email, 2 hours for chat), and guidelines on when to use which tool—a phone call for anything urgent, for instance. To my relief, the idea was met with enthusiasm. It wasn't a panacea, but it was the first step in reclaiming our focus and well-being. The efficiency of the team has improved since, and more importantly, the collective anxiety has noticeably dropped.

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21. What was the author's initial experience with remote work?

A) She found it difficult to focus without her colleagues.

B) She felt it gave her a greater sense of personal independence.

C) She was worried about being less productive than in the office.

D) She immediately felt the pressure to be available at all times.

22. What does the author identify as the main problem that developed over time?

A) Her manager became more demanding.

B) The technology the team used was unreliable.

C) There was an unspoken expectation to always be online.

D) Colleagues were not completing their work on time.

23. What did the author realize after the incident with her colleague, Mark?

A) That Mark was an unreliable team member.

B) That the team's communication habits were the underlying problem.

C) That she should have contacted her manager much earlier.

D) That remote work was ultimately unsuitable for her team.

24. What was the main purpose of the 'communications charter'?

A) To monitor employees' working hours more strictly.

B) To stop colleagues from using instant messaging.

C) To reduce the number of team meetings.

D) To establish clear and predictable rules for interaction.

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25. The author believed Mark might be ignoring her on purpose.

A) True B) False C) No Information

26. Before this incident, Mark had a history of being rather slow to respond.

A) True B) False C) No Information

27. The delay in communication from Mark was due to a problem with his computer.

A) True B) False C) No Information

28. The author created the 'communications charter' with help from her team leader.

A) True B) False C) No Information

29. The team's reaction to the proposed charter was encouraging.

A) True B) False C) No Information

PART 5

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

THE DECLINE OF TRADITIONAL RETAIL

Over the past decade, the retail landscape has undergone dramatic transformation, with traditional brick-and-mortar stores struggling to maintain their foothold in the market. The rapid rise of e-commerce has fundamentally altered consumer behavior, with convenience, variety, and competitive pricing driving customers to online shopping platforms. While some retailers have adapted by embracing digital technologies, others have faltered, leading to the closure of countless high-street stores.

One significant factor contributing to this decline is the evolving expectations of consumers. Modern-day shoppers prioritize efficiency, often opting for the ability to browse and purchase items from the comfort of their homes. Same-day delivery and personalized marketing further enhance the appeal of online shopping. John Havers, a retail analyst, explains, "Today's consumers value immediacy and tailored experiences. Traditional retail, which often relies on outdated methods, struggles to keep pace with these demands."

Economic pressures also play a vital role. The cost of maintaining physical stores, including rent and employment, adds a financial burden that many businesses cannot sustain. By contrast, online retailers operate with much lower overheads. This disparity has created a fiercely competitive environment, with online giants often undercutting their traditional counterparts on price.

However, it would be premature to declare the death of the physical store. Many successful retailers are adopting a hybrid model, blending the strengths of online and offline commerce. For instance, the concept of "click-and-collect" allows customers to shop online and pick up their purchases in-store, combining convenience with immediacy. Additionally, some brands are leveraging their physical spaces to create immersive experiences, such as interactive displays and exclusive in-store events, which cannot be replicated online.

Still, challenges remain. The loss of retail jobs and the decline of bustling high streets have social and economic repercussions, particularly in smaller communities. Moreover, the environmental impact of e-commerce, including increased packaging waste and carbon emissions from delivery services, raises important sustainability concerns.

To survive in this evolving landscape, traditional retailers must rethink their strategies, embracing innovation while maintaining a sense of community. As Havers notes, "The future of retail lies not in resisting change but in finding ways to integrate the best of both worlds."

This means that brick-and-mortar stores need to blend digital convenience with personal, in-store experiences that online platforms cannot replicate. Investing in technologies such as augmented reality, personalized marketing, and seamless omnichannel systems can help retailers meet modern consumers' expectations for speed and customization.

For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each question.

THE CHALLENGES FACING RETAIL

Traditional retail has been significantly affected by the advance of **(30)_____,** which offers convenience and competitive pricing. Consumers now expect **(31)_____**, such as same-day delivery and personalized recommendations. Physical stores face higher expenses such as **(32)_____,** and staffing costs, making it difficult to compete with online retailers. Some businesses are adopting hybrid models, including "click-and-collect" services, to combine online accessibility with in-store **(33)_____.**

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34. According to the text, what is one reason online shopping is more competitive than traditional retail?

A) It offers a wider range of products than in-store shopping.

B) It operates with significantly lower costs than physical stores.

C) It allows customers to physically inspect items before purchasing.

D) It is less affected by economic pressures like inflation.

35. What does the author suggest is critical for the survival of traditional retail?

A) Closing physical stores and focusing entirely on e-commerce.

B) Offering lower prices to rival those of online retailers.

C) Combining digital innovation with unique in-store experiences.

D) Advocating for stricter regulations on online competitors.

WRITING

You are a student at an English language school. You got an email from the principal.

Dear Student,
Next month, the school plans to organize a cultural evening. We would like to know what performances or activities students would enjoy. Please share your ideas.
The principal

Task 1.1
Write a short letter to your friend about the event and what you plan to suggest.
Write about 50 words.

Task 1.2
Write to the principal explaining your opinion and giving detailed suggestions.
Write 120–150 words.

Task 2
You are participating in an online discussion for language learners.
Topic: "Do you think learning foreign languages should be compulsory in schools?"
Give reasons and examples (180–200 words).

SPEAKING

PART 1.1

- **Do you live with your family?**
- **What do you like to do with your friends?**
- **How often do you visit your relatives?**

PART 1.2





- **Tell me what you can see in these two pictures.**
- **What are the advantages of visiting the art gallery?**
- **Do people prefer to hang out with their friends or family?**

PART 2



- **Tell me about a book you have read recently.**
- **What was the book about, and did you find it interesting?**
- **What are the benefits of reading a book?**

PART 3

The Advantages and Disadvantages of Online Learning	
Pros:	**Cons:**
• Online learning offers flexibility in terms of time and location. • It can be more affordable compared to traditional classroom learning. • It allows access to a wide range of courses and materials.	• Online learning lacks face-to-face interaction and social engagement. • It can be difficult for some students to stay motivated and self-disciplined. • It has sometimes access problems for students in remote areas.

TEST III

LISTENING

PART 1

You will hear some sentences. You will hear each sentence twice. Choose the correct reply to each sentence (A, B, or C). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

1. A) Yes, I always play football.
B) I'm waiting for the menu.
C) No, I'm not hungry today.

2. A) Only on weekends.
B) I'm going to the park.
C) Football.

3. A) I'm not very hungry.
B) It's nice.
C) I bought it last week.

4. A) I went shopping yesterday.
B) That's my favorite song.
C) Take a little rest.

5. A) Maybe tomorrow.
B) I only make pasta.
C) I'm watching a movie now.

6. A) I watched a video.
B) I am hungry.
C) It's very cold today.

7. A) Maybe next week's weather is good.
B) I am working late today, sorry.
C) Yes, I like pizza.

8. A) No, mine is black.
B) I live near the station.
C) It costs about ten dollars.

PART 2

You will hear someone giving a talk. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space. Write ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each answer.

MUSIC FESTIVAL

- Will be held in where: **(9)_____** Park.
- Duration: **(10)_____** days.
- The cost of ticket for under 12-year-old children: **(11)_____.**
- Bring along: chair or **(12)_____**.
- The gates are scheduled to open **(13)_____** a.m.
- For information:www.**(14)_____**com.

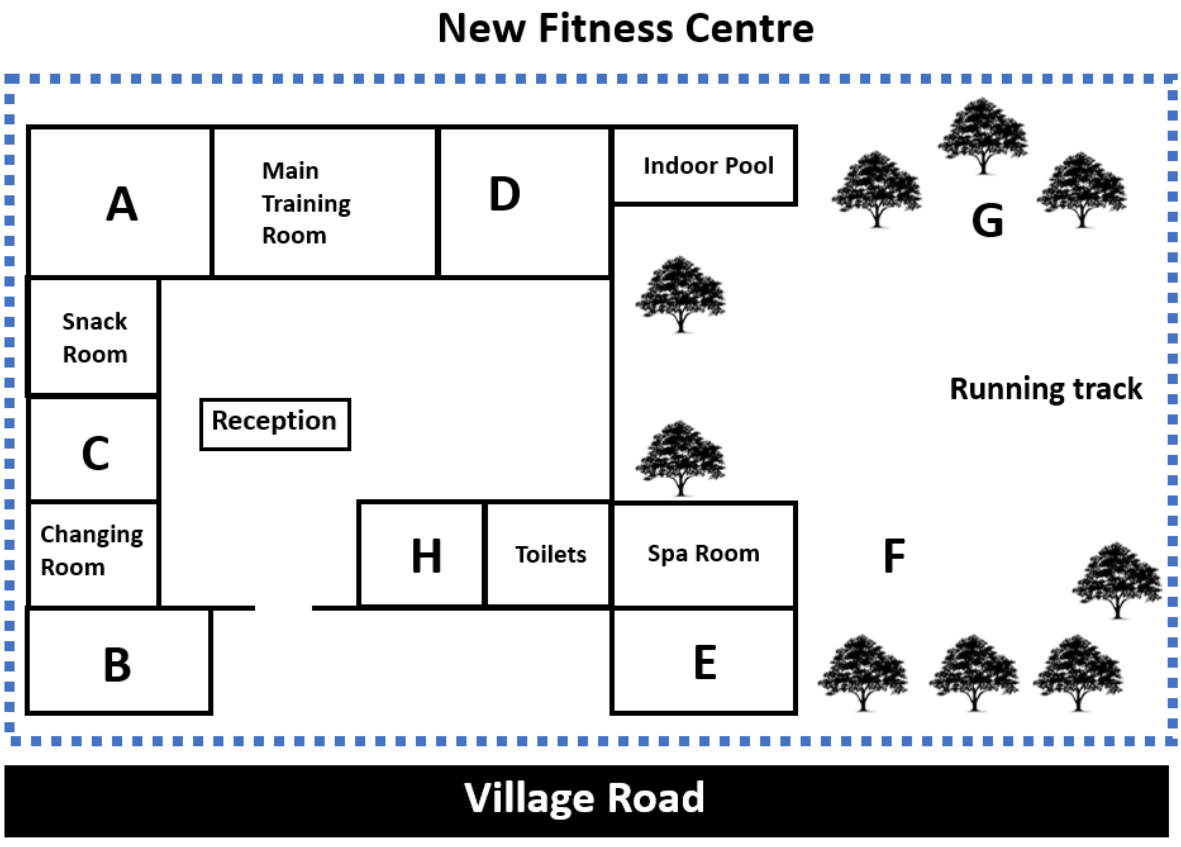
PART 3

You will hear people speaking in different situations. Match each speaker (1-4) to their descriptions about using the internet(A-F). There are TWO EXTRA options which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

	A) It makes people lose real social connections.
15. Speaker 1 …	B) It helps me earn money and work from anywhere.
16. Speaker 2 …	C) It's hard to know what information to trust.
17. Speaker 3 …	D) It's great for learning and developing new skills.
18. Speaker 4 …	E) It wastes too much time on unimportant things.
	F) It makes shopping quicker and more convenient.

PART 4

You will hear someone giving a talk. Label the places (19-23) on the map (A-H). There are THREE extra options which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.



- **19.** Car Park …
- **20.** Staff room
- **21.** Shower room …
- **22.** Outdoor gym area …
- **23.** Cycling area

PART 5

You will hear three extracts. Choose the correct answer (A, B or C) for each question (24-29). There are TWO questions for each extract. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Extract One

You will hear an interview with a woman called Adriana Moretti, who works as a wildlife photographer.

24. What disadvantage does Adriana say her work has?

A) She sometimes feels lonely when she is working abroad.
B) She doesn't see her family as often as she would like to.
C) She always has to go where the agency tells her.

25. Adriana believes it is becoming harder to get work as a wildlife photographer because …

A) so many photos of wildlife are available on the Internet.
B) there is a lot of competition for jobs in wildlife photography.
C) people are becoming less interested in wildlife.

Extract Two

You will hear an interview with travel writer Amy McCarthy about her first experience of travelling abroad.

26. When she was at the airport, Amy felt …

A) glad she had taken sandwiches with her.
B) worried that she might miss her plane.
C) annoyed that she had spent so much.

27. Amy's friend Carla annoyed Amy because Carla …

A) sometimes left dirty dishes in the living room.
B) often forgot her keys when she went out.
C) wouldn't do any food shopping.

Extract Three

You will hear an interview with someone who was involved in the music business.

28. What does James say about his ideas?

A) Some of them are not very realistic.
B) He expects to have good ones all the time.
C) He makes sure that he doesn't forget them.

29. James's advice to listeners who might want to go into business is to …

A) forget about past problems.
B) learn from past mistakes.
C) take big risks.

PART 6

You will hear a part of a lecture. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space. Write no more than ONE WORD for each answer.

ARCHERY



- Anne used to shoot arrows from a bow made of plastic when she was a child.
- Anne only had time to read about the **(30)**_____ of archery before the beginner's archery course.
- Anne's archery course took place in a **(31)**_____.
- Anne was surprised that learning to **(32)**_____ properly was so difficult.
- The teacher told Anne she needed to relax her shoulders.
- One of Anne's arrows went into a **(33)**_____ by accident.
- During the breaks, Ann was happy to look at the **(34)**_____ and talk to other people.
- Some of the people on Anne's course said that a TV series had inspired them to try archery.
- Anne is trying to persuade her **(35)**_____ to do an archery course with her.

READING

PART 1

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

THE AMAZING TRANSFORMATION OF A BUTTERFLY



The life of a butterfly is a story of incredible change. This journey, known as metamorphosis, has four distinct stages. It all starts when a female butterfly lays a tiny egg, usually on a leaf or stem. This plant will serve as the first food for the creature that hatches from the **(1)_____.**

Soon, a small larva, which we call a caterpillar, emerges. The primary job of the caterpillar is to eat. It munches on leaves, growing bigger and bigger very quickly. As it grows, this hungry **(2)_____** sheds its skin multiple times. Once it reaches its full size, it prepares for the most magical part of its life.

The caterpillar finds a safe spot and forms a protective casing around itself. This casing is called a chrysalis. Inside the **(3)_____,** the caterpillar's body completely transforms. It might look like nothing is happening from the outside, but a remarkable change is taking place.

After a period of time, which can be weeks or months, a beautiful butterfly breaks free from the casing. At first, its wings are soft and folded. The new **(4)_____** must pump fluid into its wings to make them strong enough for flight. After resting, the butterfly with its colorful **(5)_____** will fly away to drink nectar from flowers. This entire process of change is called metamorphosis, and it is one of nature's most amazing wonders. Understanding **(6)_____** shows us how living things can adapt and change in extraordinary ways.

PART 2

Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only. There are TWO extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A. You want to join a practical session that lets you try out acting techniques in front of an audience.
B. You're eager to spend an evening tasting cuisine from around the world.
C. You're travelling with children and want an event that combines entertainment with creative learning.
D. You enjoy architecture and want a guided experience that uncovers the city's lesser-known heritage.
E. You're hoping to meet other creative people and show your artwork publicly.
F. You'd like to attend a festival that includes open-air melodic performances by international artists.
G. You want a relaxed activity where you can produce something handmade to take home.
H. You're interested in short films that focus on social themes and want to hear from the directors afterwards.
I. You'd like a weekend course focused on improving your photography skills.
J. You're looking for a cultural activity that helps you forget daily stress through mindfulness and calm surroundings.

7. Clay & Calm Studio
Our pottery classes combine art and relaxation. Under gentle instruction, participants shape and paint their own ceramic pieces in a peaceful studio overlooking the river. Most guests say they leave feeling refreshed and creative. A small exhibition of participants' best works is held once a month, though taking part is optional.

8. Old Streets Story Walk
Step away from tourist crowds and explore hidden courtyards, forgotten monuments, and unusual tales that never appear in guidebooks. Ideal for those who like history with a touch of mystery. The route also passes a few popular cafés, where the group can stop for refreshments.

9. Screen Voices Festival
An annual showcase of independent cinema highlighting current social issues. After selected screenings, filmmakers hold discussions about what inspired their work and how audiences can get involved. Between sessions, visitors can browse a small market selling posters and film merchandise.

10. Global Flavours Evening

Spend an unforgettable night sampling signature dishes prepared by chefs from several countries. Guests are invited to chat with the cooks and learn about the traditions behind each recipe. A short cultural performance follows dinner, but the main focus remains on the food experience.

11. Young Minds Arts Day

A lively event designed for families. Children can paint murals, build musical instruments, and watch storytelling performances while parents enjoy local food stalls. Teen volunteers help run each activity, encouraging teamwork and problem-solving skills.

12. Night Under the Stars Concerts

Every Friday in summer, the park fills with music from jazz to world folk. Visitors bring blankets, listen to international performers, and enjoy the open-air atmosphere. Some evenings also feature local dance groups before the main musical acts begin.

13. City Frame Photography Retreat

This two-day course helps participants develop both camera and digital-editing skills. Outdoor photo walks are followed by feedback sessions in a creative studio. Although accommodation isn't included, nearby guesthouses offer discounts for attendees.

14. Stage Steps Workshop

Discover what it's like to perform on stage! This intensive workshop introduces improvisation, voice control, and teamwork, ending with a short showcase for friends and family. Previous participants have used the skills they learned here to gain confidence in public speaking.

PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

LIST OF HEADINGS

A) The negative effects of insufficient rest
B) A historical overview of sleep research
C) Practical advice for improving sleep quality
D) The role of dreams in emotional processing
E) Defining the fundamental stages of slumber
F) The essential functions of sleep for body and mind
G) How sleep patterns change throughout a person's life
H) An explanation of the body's internal clock

15. Paragraph I
16. Paragraph II
17. Paragraph III
18. Paragraph IV
19. Paragraph V
20. Paragraph VI

THE SCIENCE OF SLEEP

I. Sleep is a universal biological necessity, yet its precise mechanisms are still being explored. Far from being a passive state, sleep is a highly active period for the brain. It is governed by two main processes: the circadian rhythm, our internal 24-hour clock that tells us when to feel sleepy and when to be alert, and sleep pressure, which builds up the longer we are awake, creating a growing need for rest.

II. The architecture of sleep is complex, consisting of a recurring pattern of distinct phases. A typical night's sleep cycles between Non-Rapid Eye Movement (NREM) and Rapid Eye Movement (REM) sleep. NREM is further divided into three stages, progressing from light dozing to deep, restorative sleep. REM sleep, in contrast, is when the brain is highly active, breathing becomes irregular, and most vivid dreaming occurs. A full cycle through all stages takes approximately 90–110 minutes.

III. The reasons why we dedicate roughly a third of our lives to sleep are multifaceted. Physically, sleep is crucial for cellular repair, muscle growth, and the release of important hormones. Cognitively, it is indispensable for memory consolidation—the process by which recent learned experiences are transformed into long-term memory. It also allows the brain to clear out metabolic waste products that accumulate during waking hours.

IV. A chronic lack of sleep can have serious and wide-ranging consequences for health and well-being. In the short term, it leads to impaired concentration, poor decision-making, and mood swings. Over the long term, sleep deprivation is linked to an increased risk of significant health problems, including obesity, diabetes, cardiovascular disease, and a weakened immune system, making us more susceptible to infections.

V. Given its importance, cultivating good sleep hygiene is vital. Experts recommend maintaining a consistent sleep-wake schedule, even on weekends, to regulate the body's clock. Creating a relaxing bedtime routine, such as reading a book or taking a warm bath, can signal to the brain that it's time to wind down. It is also crucial to ensure the bedroom environment is dark, quiet, and cool, and to avoid stimulants like caffeine and electronic screens before bed.

VI. As people age, their sleep patterns often shift. Teenagers tend to fall asleep later and struggle to wake early, while older adults may become early risers and experience lighter, more fragmented sleep. These changes are influenced by hormonal variations and alterations in the body’s circadian rhythm. Understanding such natural shifts helps explain why sleep needs and habits vary across different stages of life.

PART 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

THE POWER OF SMELL

For most people, sight and hearing are the dominant senses, while smell is often considered less important. Yet research increasingly shows that our sense of smell plays a far greater role in daily life than we realise. From influencing our emotions and memories to shaping our social connections, scent can quietly guide our thoughts and behaviour in powerful ways.

The human nose can detect over a trillion different odours, although we are rarely conscious of this ability. When we encounter a familiar fragrance, it can instantly transport us to a specific moment in the past — a phenomenon known as "odor-evoked memory." For example, the smell of fresh rain might remind someone of their childhood garden. Scientists have found that smells trigger more vivid and emotional memories than visual or auditory cues, partly because the olfactory system is directly linked to the brain's limbic region, which processes emotions and memory.

In recent years, psychologists have explored how scent can affect mood and performance. One study discovered that people exposed to the smell of lavender became calmer and performed better on memory tests, while the scent of lemon made participants feel more alert. Retailers have even begun using this knowledge: a pleasant fragrance in a shop can subtly encourage customers to stay longer and spend more money. However, the effects of scent are not universal. A smell that one person finds soothing may be irritating to another, depending on personal associations and cultural background.

Interestingly, our ability to recognise and interpret smells can also influence social behaviour. Research suggests that people subconsciously use body odour to detect emotions such as fear or happiness in others. Some scientists believe that this hidden form of chemical communication evolved to help early humans survive by warning each other of danger or signalling trust. Despite these ancient roots, the modern world has largely masked natural body scents through perfumes and deodorants, reducing our awareness of this subtle form of interaction.

While smell has clear benefits, it can also cause problems. Individuals who lose their sense of smell — a condition known as anosmia — often report feelings of isolation or depression. Without the emotional richness that smells provide, many find that food becomes less enjoyable and that they struggle to recall certain memories. Fortunately, advances in neuroscience are helping researchers understand how to restore or strengthen olfactory function, offering hope to those affected.

Although we rarely stop to think about it, smell continues to shape our thoughts, decisions, and relationships in countless invisible ways. The next time a familiar aroma catches your attention, it might be worth pausing — your nose could be telling you more than you think.

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21. What is the main point made in the first paragraph?

A) Smell is less influential than other senses.

B) People underestimate the impact of smell in their lives.

C) The sense of smell is primarily used for safety.

D) Smell affects people only in limited situations.

22. According to the passage, why do scents trigger strong memories?

A) Because they are easier to identify than sounds or images.

B) Because the brain stores smell information more efficiently.

C) Because they connect directly with emotional parts of the brain.

D) Because people consciously link smells with past events.

23. What conclusion can be drawn from research involving lavender and lemon scents?

A) Different smells can influence mood and behaviour in specific ways.

B) People react to fragrances in the same way across all cultures.

C) Pleasant scents always improve focus and concentration.

D) Fragrances affect mood only when people are aware of them.

24. What problem is mentioned in connection with anosmia?

A) It can cause people to become physically ill.

B) It may reduce emotional well-being and quality of life.

C) It affects people's ability to recognise colours and sounds.

D) It can permanently damage other sensory systems.

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25. Memories triggered by smells usually last longer than those triggered by sounds.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

26. Retailers use specific scents to influence customers' behaviour in stores.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

27. Scientists have proven that all people find the smell of lavender relaxing.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

28. Natural body odours once played a role in early human communication.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

29. Modern perfumes have completely destroyed the human sense of smell.

A) True B) False C) Not Given

PART 5

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

THE PARADOX OF CHOICE

In the modern world, consumers are surrounded by extraordinary abundance. Supermarkets, online platforms, and streaming services all promise endless possibilities — from thousands of breakfast cereals to millions of songs and movies. At first glance, this variety might appear to enhance personal freedom, giving people the ability to shape their experiences exactly as they wish. Yet psychologists argue that too many options can actually have the opposite effect. Instead of feeling liberated, individuals often become overwhelmed and stressed by the sheer number of decisions they must make each day.

The American psychologist Barry Schwartz introduced the term “the paradox of choice” to describe this phenomenon. His research suggests that when people face an excess of options, they experience decision fatigue and anxiety, often ending up less satisfied with their final choices. In one well-known experiment, shoppers presented with only six kinds of jam were far more likely to make a purchase than those offered twenty-four varieties. The conclusion was clear: a smaller number of choices makes decision-making both easier and more enjoyable.

However, not all scholars fully agree with Schwartz’s interpretation. Critics argue that the negative consequences of abundance depend largely on the context. For instance, individuals used to making complex decisions — such as investors, doctors, or managers — may actually thrive in environments with a wide range of alternatives. Others note that digital tools such as filters, search engines, and recommendation algorithms can simplify the process, allowing consumers to handle vast selections efficiently rather than feeling lost in them.

Cultural differences further complicate the picture. In some societies, the ability to choose freely is strongly associated with independence and personal identity, while in others, it is viewed as a potential source of pressure or confusion. Research shows that Western consumers often regard variety as empowering, whereas people from more collectivist cultures may prefer fewer, clearer choices. This suggests that the “paradox of choice” may not be a universal psychological truth, but rather a reflection of different cultural values and expectations.

Ultimately, the relationship between freedom and choice remains complex. Having multiple options can promote individuality and autonomy, yet an excess of them may undermine satisfaction and well-being. The challenge for modern societies is to strike the right balance — offering enough variety to support personal freedom without creating a sense of paralysis or discontent.

For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each question.

According to the passage, people often feel **(30)_____** when confronted with too many choices.
Schwartz's experiment with jam demonstrated that consumers are more likely to buy when options are **(31)_____**.
Critics believe that the effect of excessive choice can vary depending on the **(32)_____** in which decisions are made.
Cultural research indicates that the link between choice and **(33)_____** differs across societies.

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34. What is one argument used by those who challenge Schwartz's theory?
A) Most people prefer to avoid making any choices at all.
B) Technological aids can make decision-making simpler despite large selections.
C) Consumers in all cultures experience the same reaction to abundance.
D) There is no psychological basis for the paradox of choice.

35. What message does the writer convey in the final paragraph?
A) Excessive choice is unavoidable in the modern world.
B) Freedom of choice always results in greater happiness.
C) Societies must balance individual autonomy with simplicity.
D) Limiting variety is the only way to ensure satisfaction.

WRITING

You are a member of the Travel Club at your language center. You received an email from the club organizer.

Dear Member,
We are planning our trips for next year and would like to hear your thoughts.
Which city would you like to visit and why?
When do you think would be the best time for the trip?
Would you prefer to go with your family or just with other club members?
Your suggestions will help us organize a more enjoyable trip for everyone.
Best wishes,
Travel Club Organizer

Task 1.1
Write a short email to your friend (who is also a member of the travel club).
Say what city you'd like to visit, when, and whether you want to go with your family.
Write about 50 words.

Task 1.2
Write an email to the travel club organizer.
Give your opinion about the next trip.
Suggest a city to visit, explain when the best time would be, and whether it should be a family trip or not.
Write 120–150 words.

Task 2.
You are participating in an online discussion for language learners.
The question is:
"Some people say a vegetarian diet is better for health. Do you agree?"
Post your response, giving reasons and examples. Write 180–200 words.

SPEAKING

TASK 1.1

- **What time do you usually wake up in the morning?**
- **How do you get to work/school?**
- **How much time do you spend on your hobbies?**

TASK 1.2





- **Tell me what you can see in these two pictures.**
- **What are the advantages of teaching students?**
- **What qualities should teachers have?**

TASK 2



- **Tell me about a situation where you helped someone.**
- **Who did you help and how did you help them?**
- **How do people usually feel when they help others?**

TASK 3

The Benefits and Drawbacks of Urbanization	
Pros:	**Cons:**
• Urbanization leads to the development of better infrastructure and public services. • It can provide more job opportunities and economic growth. • Urban areas often offer better access to education, healthcare, and cultural activities.	• Rapid urbanization can lead to overcrowding and increased pollution. • It may cause the loss of natural habitats and biodiversity. • High living costs in cities can lead to inequality and poverty.